

The Pol-InSAR Course

Part 5: SAR Interferometry 3

Prepared by DLR-HR's Pol-InSAR Team

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ESAMAAP

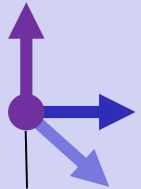
EEBI  **MASS**



S_1

SAR Interferometry for Volume Structure

Height (z)



Ground
Range

Slant Range (r)





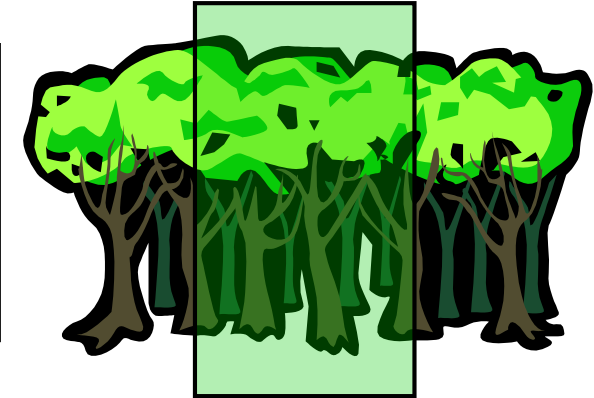
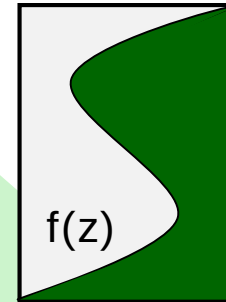
Interferometric
Coherence

$$\tilde{\gamma}(S_1, S_2) = \frac{\langle S_1 S_2^* \rangle}{\sqrt{\langle S_1 S_1^* \rangle \langle S_2 S_2^* \rangle}}$$

SAR Interferometry for Volume Structure

Volume
Coherence

$$\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}(f(z), k_z) = e^{ik_z z_0} \frac{\int_0^{h_v} f(z) e^{ik_z z} dz}{\int_0^{h_v} f(z) dz}$$



$f(z)$... vertical reflectivity function

Vertical Wavenumber: $k_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$

$$\tilde{\gamma} = \tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Temporal}} \gamma_{\text{SNR}} \tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}$$

- $\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Temporal}}$... temporal decorrelation
- γ_{SNR} ... additive noise decorrelation
- $\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Volume}}$... geometric decorrelation



 S_1 S_2 

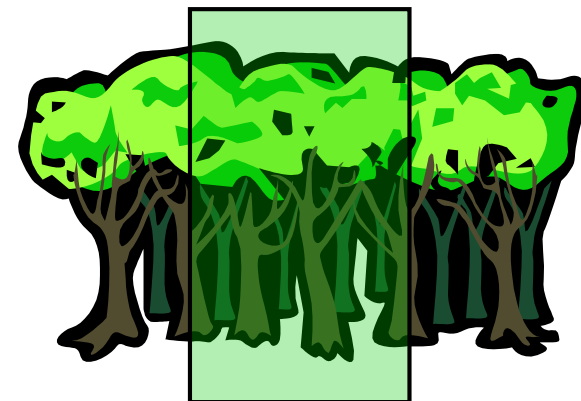
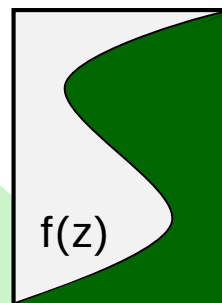
Interferometric
Coherence

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SAR Interferometry for Volume Structure

Volume
Coherence

$$\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}(f(z), k_z) = e^{ik_z z_0} \frac{\int_0^{h_v} f(z) e^{ik_z z} dz}{\int_0^{h_v} f(z) dz}$$



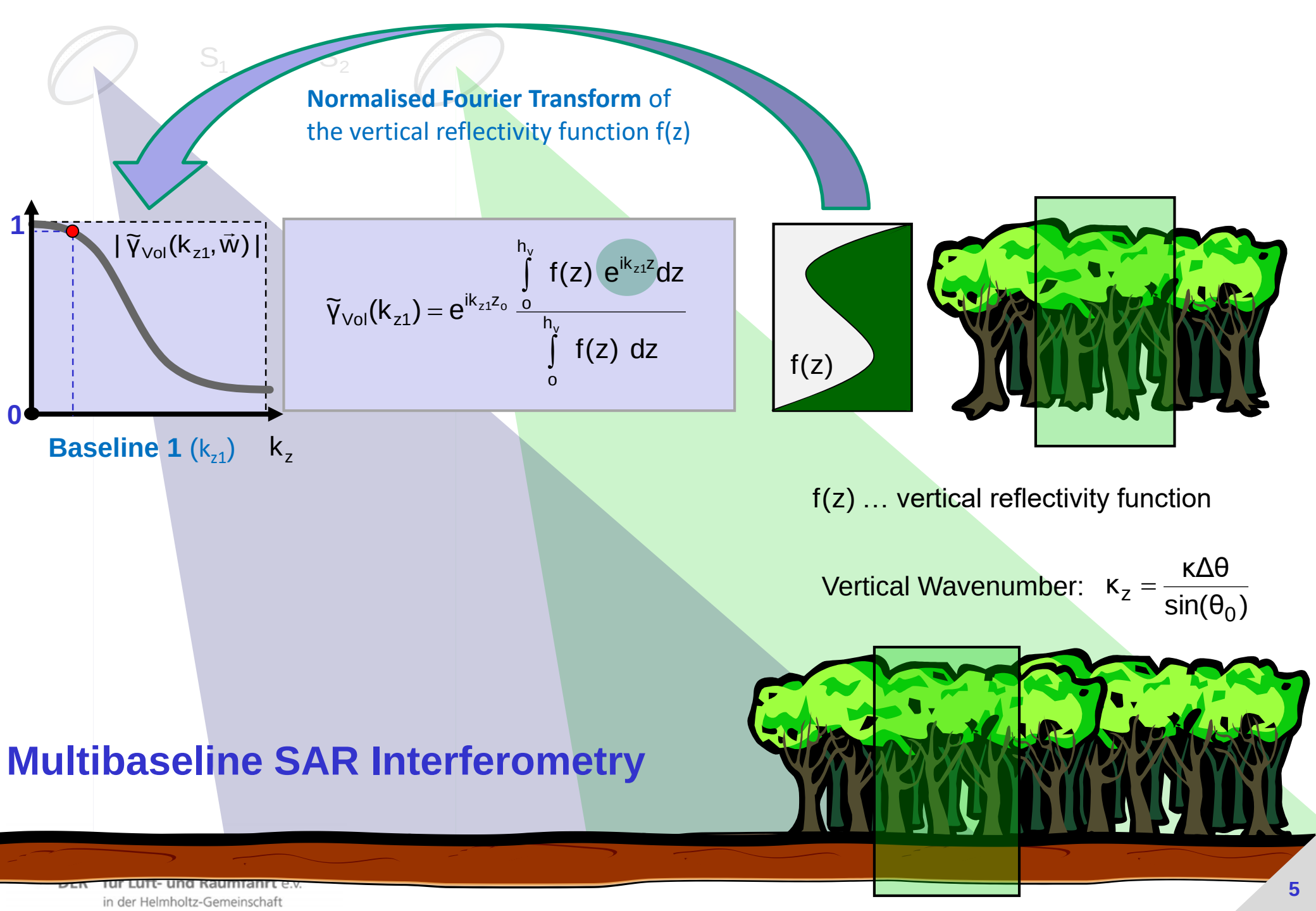
$f(z)$... vertical reflectivity function

Vertical Wavenumber: $k_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$

$$\tilde{\gamma} = \tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Temporal}} \gamma_{\text{SNR}} \tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}$$

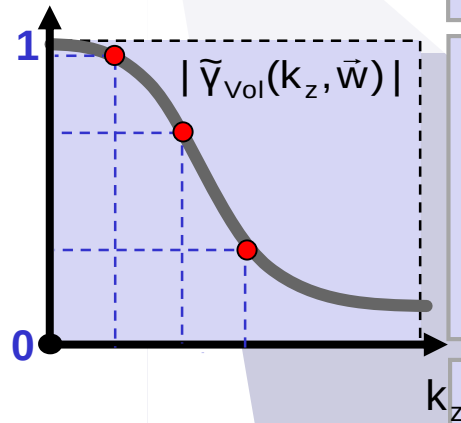
- $\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Temporal}}$... temporal decorrelation
- γ_{SNR} ... additive noise decorrelation
- $\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Volume}}$... geometric decorrelation

SAR interferometry allows to reconstruct the vertical reflectivity function $f(z)$ of a volume scatterer by means of interferometric (volume) coherence measurements at different vertical wavenumbers k_z , i.e. at different spatial baselines.



 S_1
Baseline 3 (k_{z3})

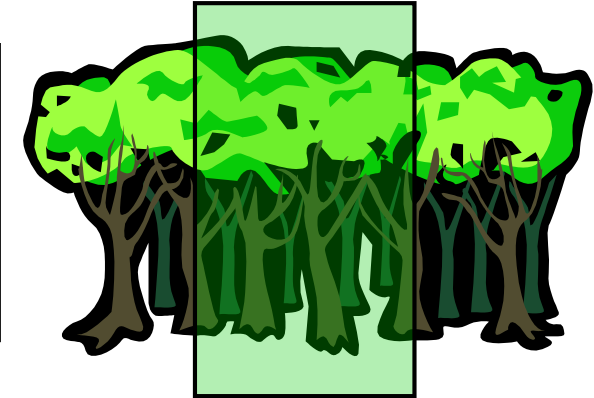
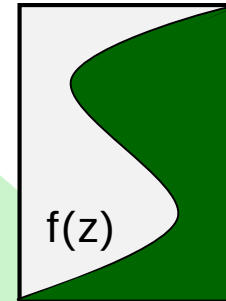
$$\tilde{Y}_{\text{Vol}}(k_{z3}) = e^{ik_{z3}z_0} \frac{\int_0^{h_y} f(z) e^{ik_{z3}z} dz}{\int_0^{h_y} f(z) dz}$$



Baseline 2 (k_{z2})

$$\tilde{Y}_{\text{Vol}}(k_{z1}) = e^{ik_{z1}z_0} \frac{\int_0^{h_y} f(z) e^{ik_{z1}z} dz}{\int_0^{h_y} f(z) dz}$$

$$\tilde{Y}_{\text{Vol}}(k_{z2}) = e^{ik_{z2}z_0} \frac{\int_0^{h_y} f(z) e^{ik_{z2}z} dz}{\int_0^{h_y} f(z) dz}$$



$f(z)$... vertical reflectivity function

Vertical Wavenumber: $k_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$



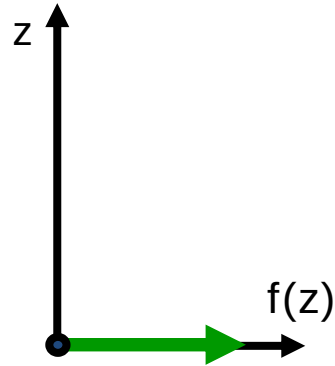
Multibaseline SAR Interferometry

Multi-baseline measurements allow to sample the spectrum of the vertical reflectivity $\text{FT}\{f(z)\}$ @ different (spatial) frequencies (k_z).

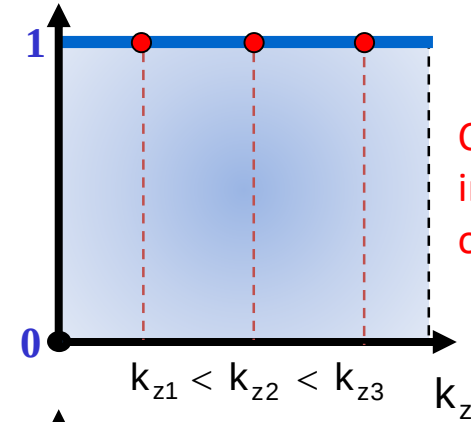
Vertical Reflectivity Function $f(z)$

InSAR Volume Coherence $|\tilde{\gamma}_{Vol}(k_z)|$

Surface Scatterer

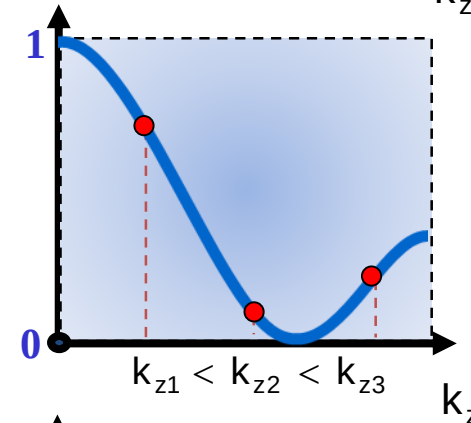
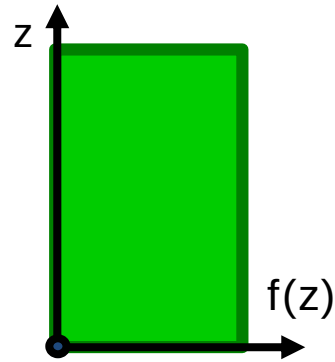


$$|\tilde{\gamma}_{Vol}(k_z)| = \frac{\left| \int_0^{h_v} f(z) e^{ik_z z} dz \right|}{\int_0^{h_v} f(z) dz}$$



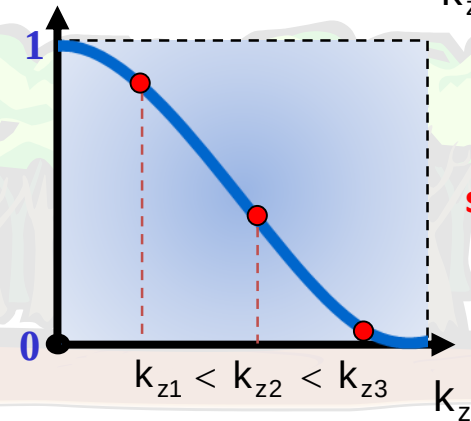
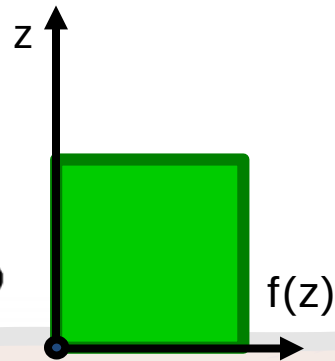
Coherence is independent of baseline

Tall Vegetation



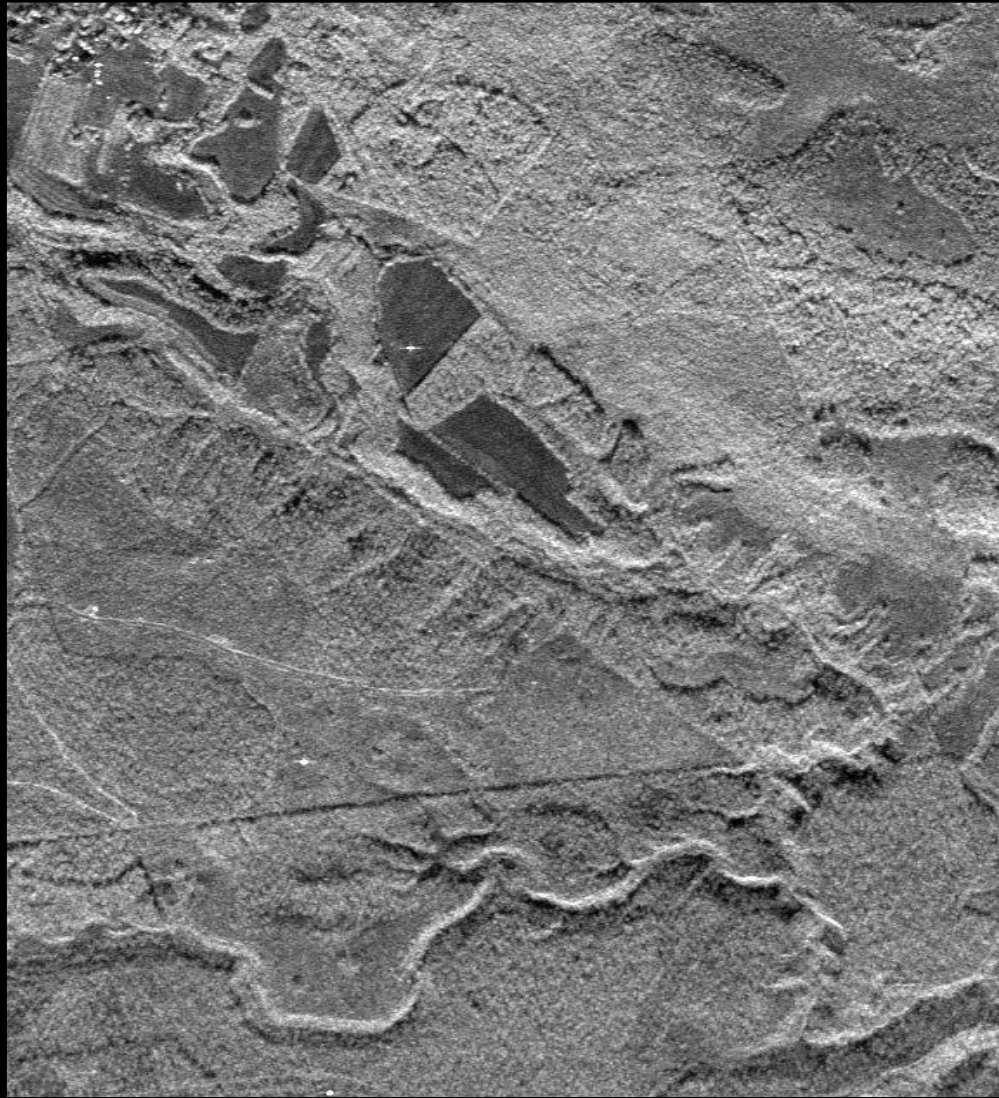
Coherence decreases with increasing baseline

Short Vegetation

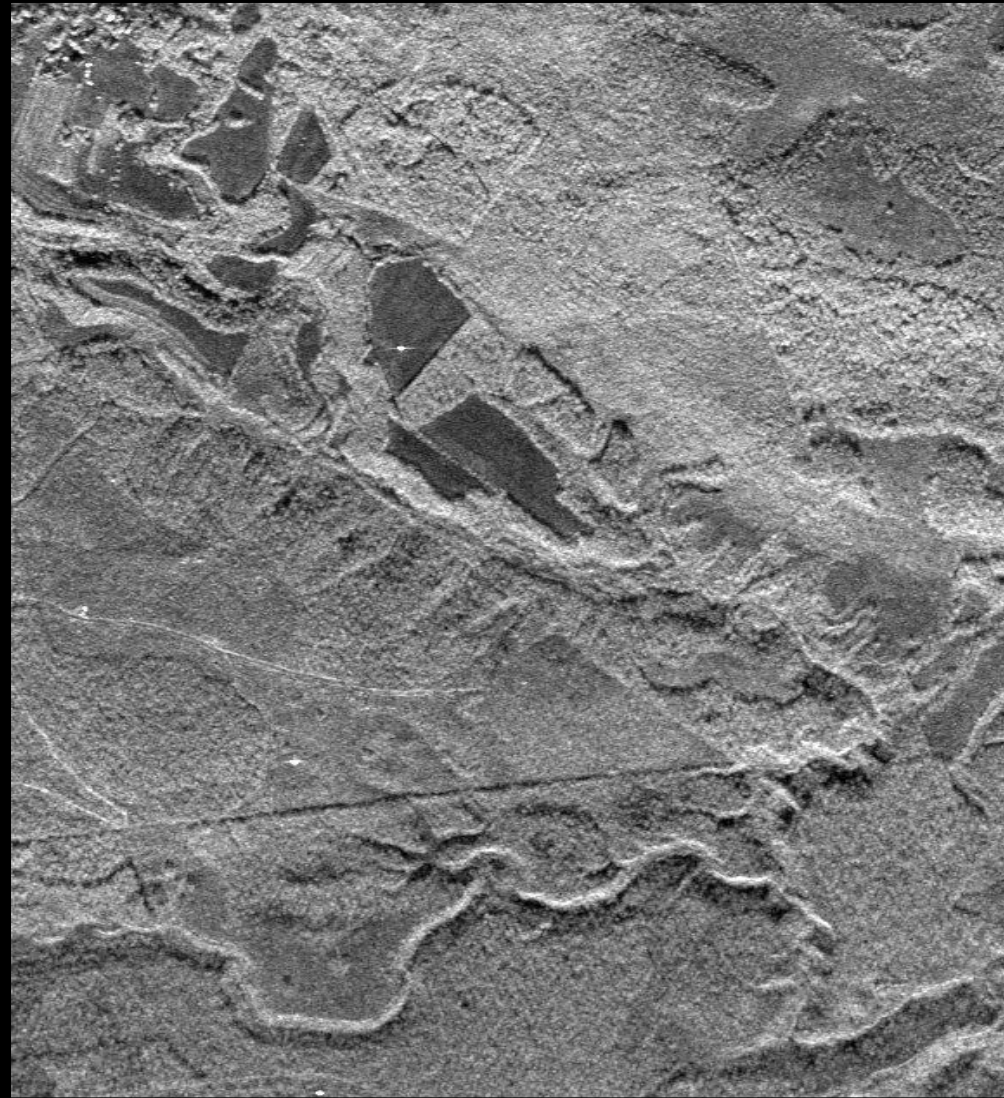


Coherence decreases **slower** with increasing baseline

Airborne (E-SAR) Single-Pass Interferometry: X-Band



08biosar0405x1_t01 XTI half baseline



08biosar0407x1_t01 XTI full baseline

Airborne (E-SAR) Single-Pass Interferometry: X-Band

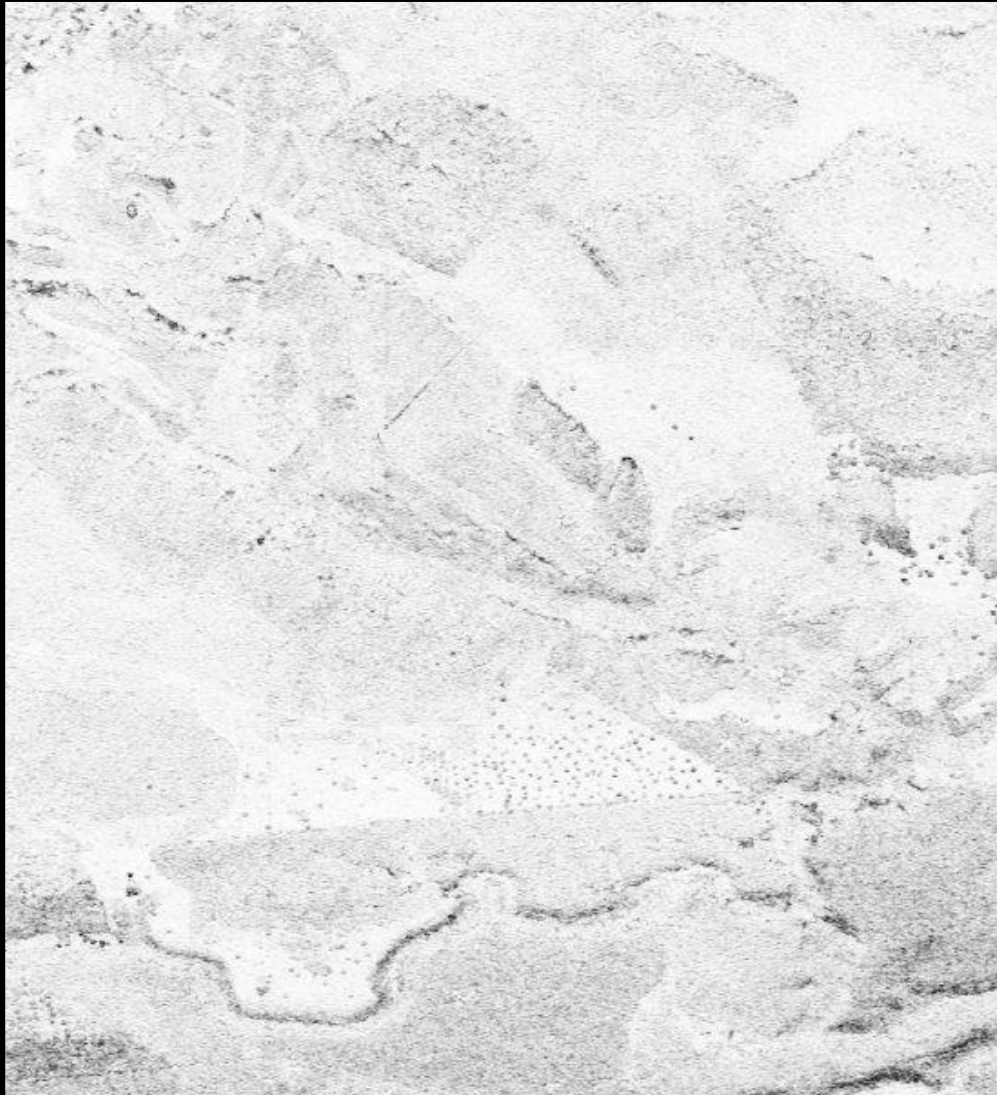


08biosar0405x1_t01 XTI half baseline, $k_z = 0.6$ rad/m



08biosar0407x1_t01 XTI full baseline, $k_z = 1.2$ rad/m

Airborne (E-SAR) Single-Pass Interferometry: X-Band



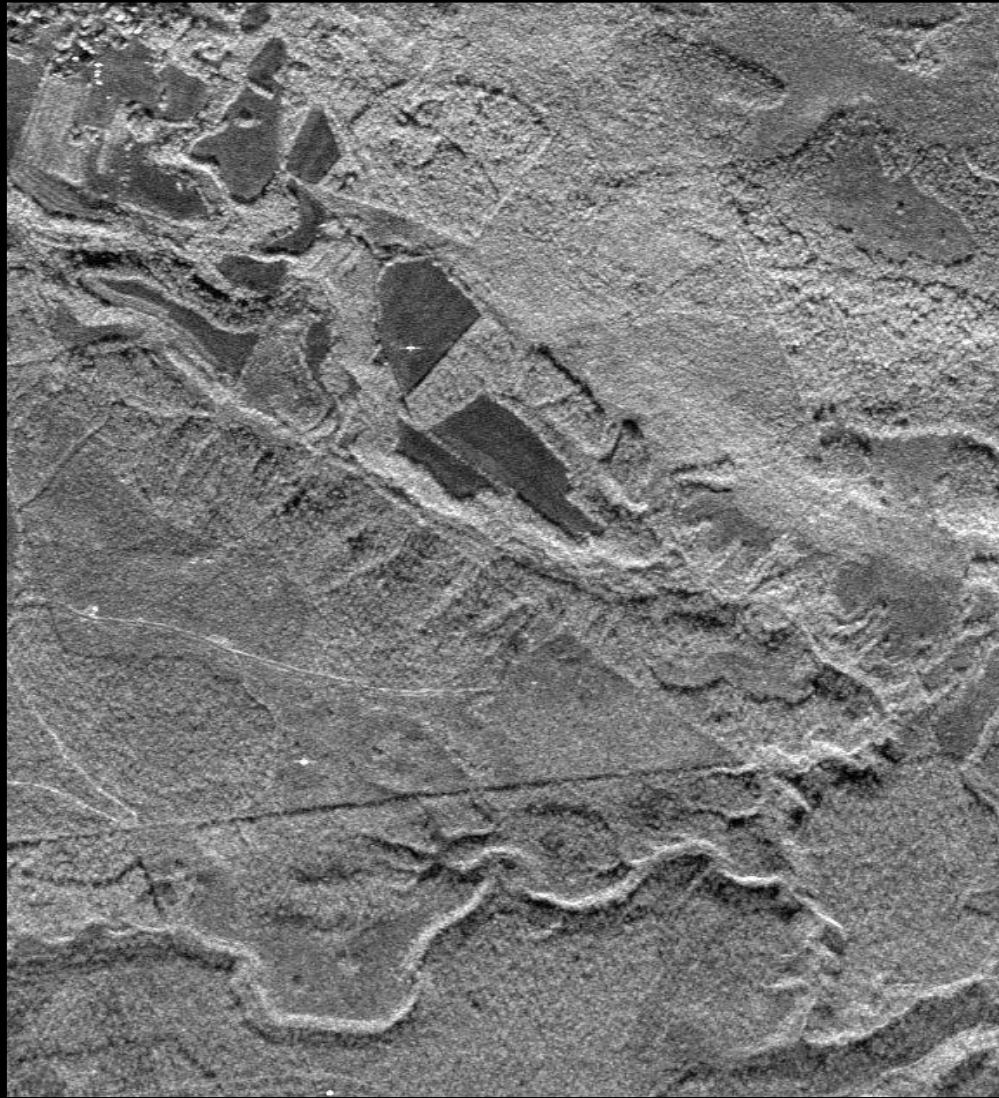
08biosar0405x1_t01 XTI half baseline, $k_z = 0.6$ rad/m



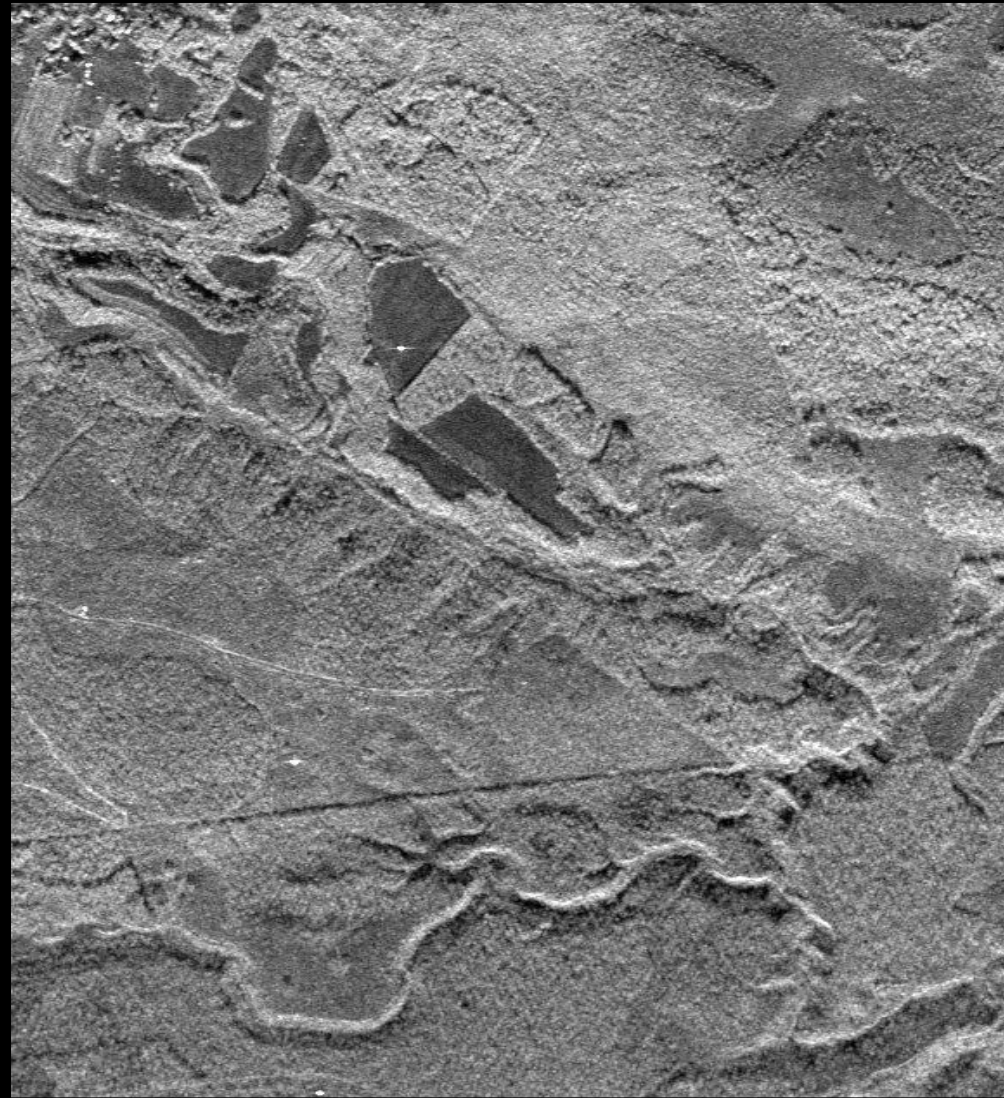
08biosar0407x1_t01 XTI full baseline, $k_z = 1.2$ rad/m

$$Y = Y_{\text{Temporal}} \cdot Y_{\text{SNR}} \cdot Y_{\text{Vol}}$$

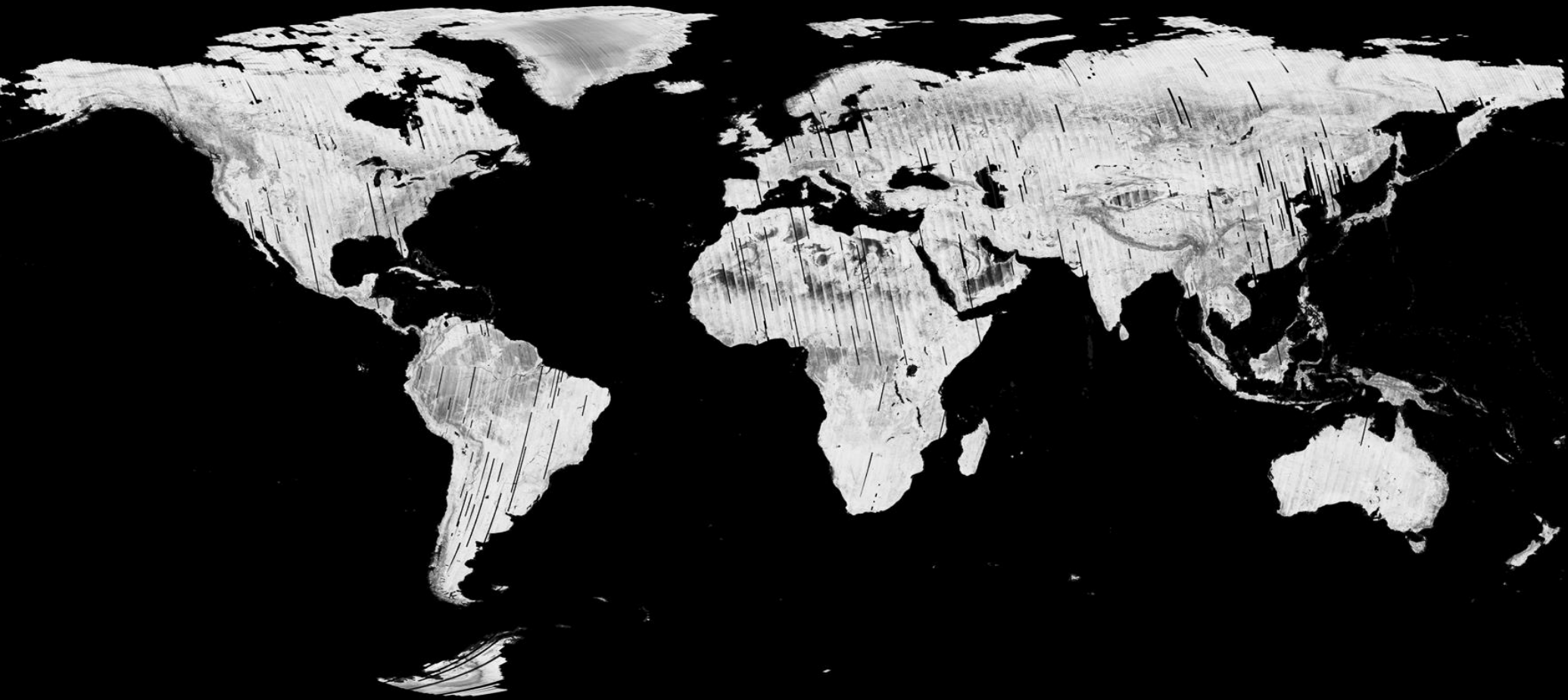
Airborne (E-SAR) Single-Pass Interferometry: X-Band



08biosar0405x1_t01 XTI half baseline



08biosar0407x1_t01 XTI full baseline



0

1

$\gamma = \gamma_{\text{Temporal}} \gamma_{\text{SNR}} \gamma_{\text{Vol}}$



By DLR-HR-STL

500x500 m² resolution



0

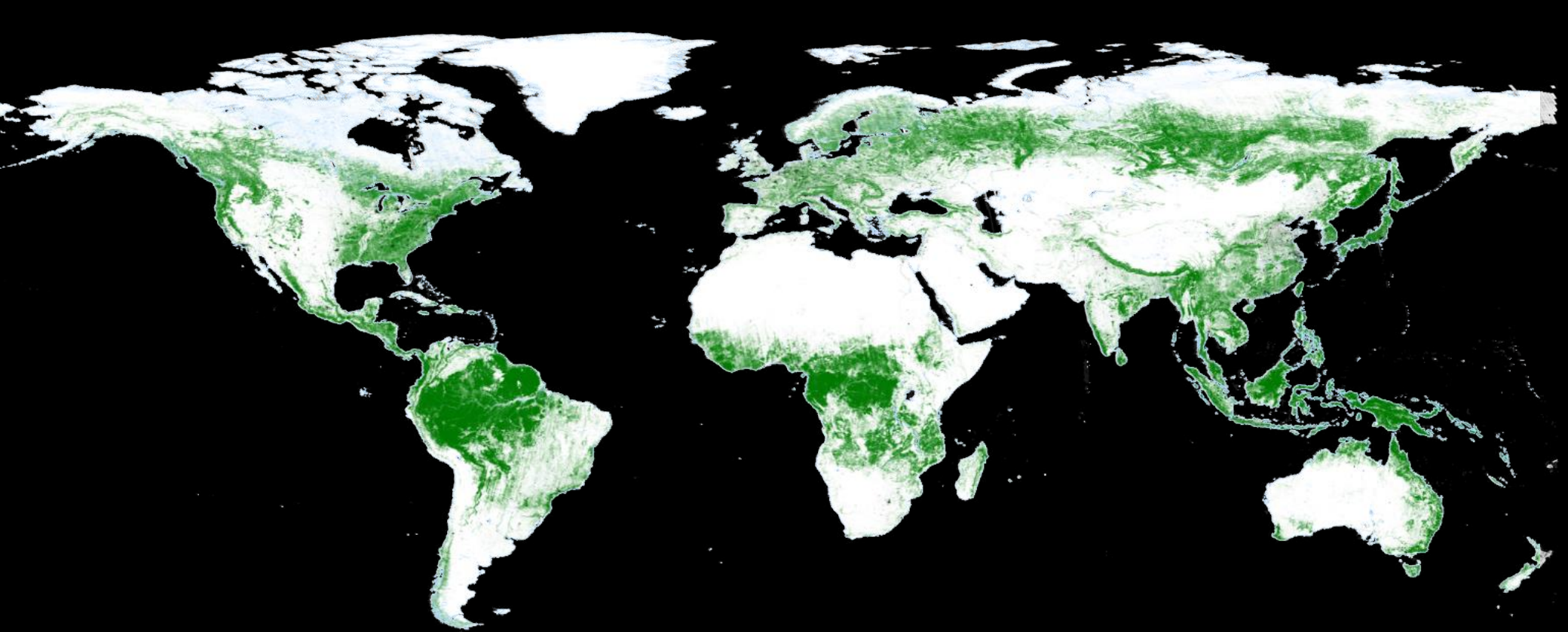
1

$Y = Y_{\text{Temporal}} Y_{\text{SNR}} Y_{\text{Vol}}$



By DLR-HR-STL

500x500 m² resolution



Forest – Non Forest Map



By DLR-HR-STL

50x50 m² resolution



S_1

S_2



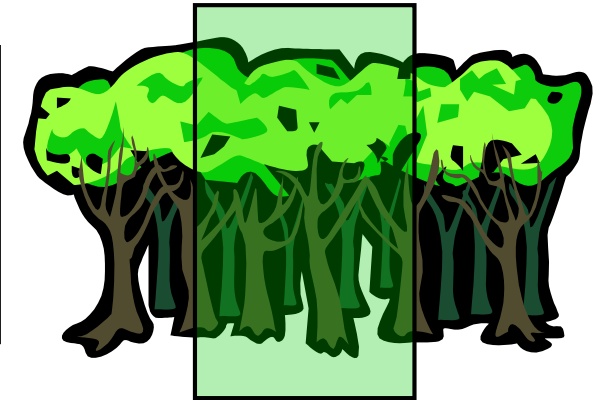
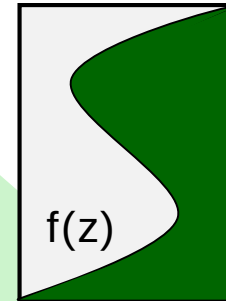
Interferometric
Coherence

$$\tilde{\gamma}(S_1, S_2) = \frac{\langle S_1 S_2^* \rangle}{\sqrt{\langle S_1 S_1^* \rangle \langle S_2 S_2^* \rangle}}$$

SAR Interferometry for Volume Structure

Volume
Coherence

$$\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}(f(z), k_z) = e^{ik_z z_0} \frac{\int_0^{h_v} f(z) e^{ik_z z} dz}{\int_0^{h_v} f(z) dz}$$



$f(z)$... vertical reflectivity function

Vertical Wavenumber: $k_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$

$$\tilde{\gamma} = \tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Temporal}} \gamma_{\text{SNR}} \tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}$$

- $\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Temporal}}$... temporal decorrelation
- γ_{SNR} ... additive noise decorrelation
- $\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Volume}}$... geometric decorrelation





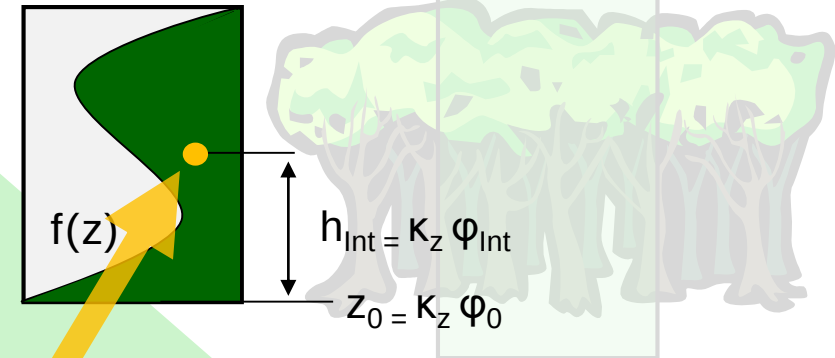
Interferometric
Coherence

$$\tilde{\gamma}(S_1, S_2) = \frac{\langle S_1 S_2^* \rangle}{\sqrt{\langle S_1 S_1^* \rangle \langle S_2 S_2^* \rangle}}$$

SAR Interferometry for Volume Structure

Volume
Coherence

$$\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}(f(z), k_z) = e^{ik_z z_0} \frac{\int_0^{h_v} f(z) e^{ik_z z} dz}{\int_0^{h_v} f(z) dz}$$



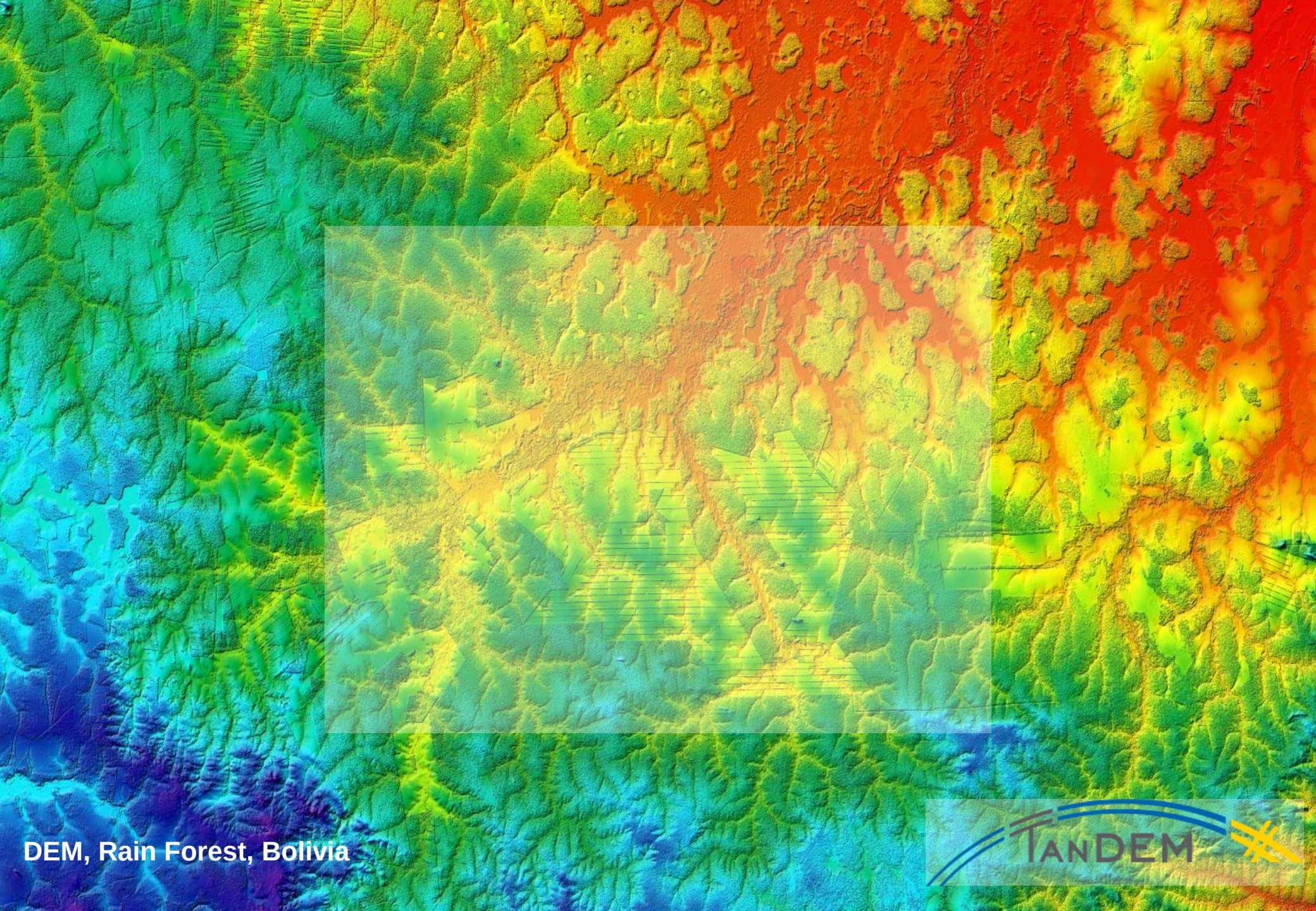
$f(z)$... vertical reflectivity function

Vertical Wavenumber: $k_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$

$$\tilde{\gamma} = \tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Temporal}} \gamma_{\text{SNR}} \tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}$$

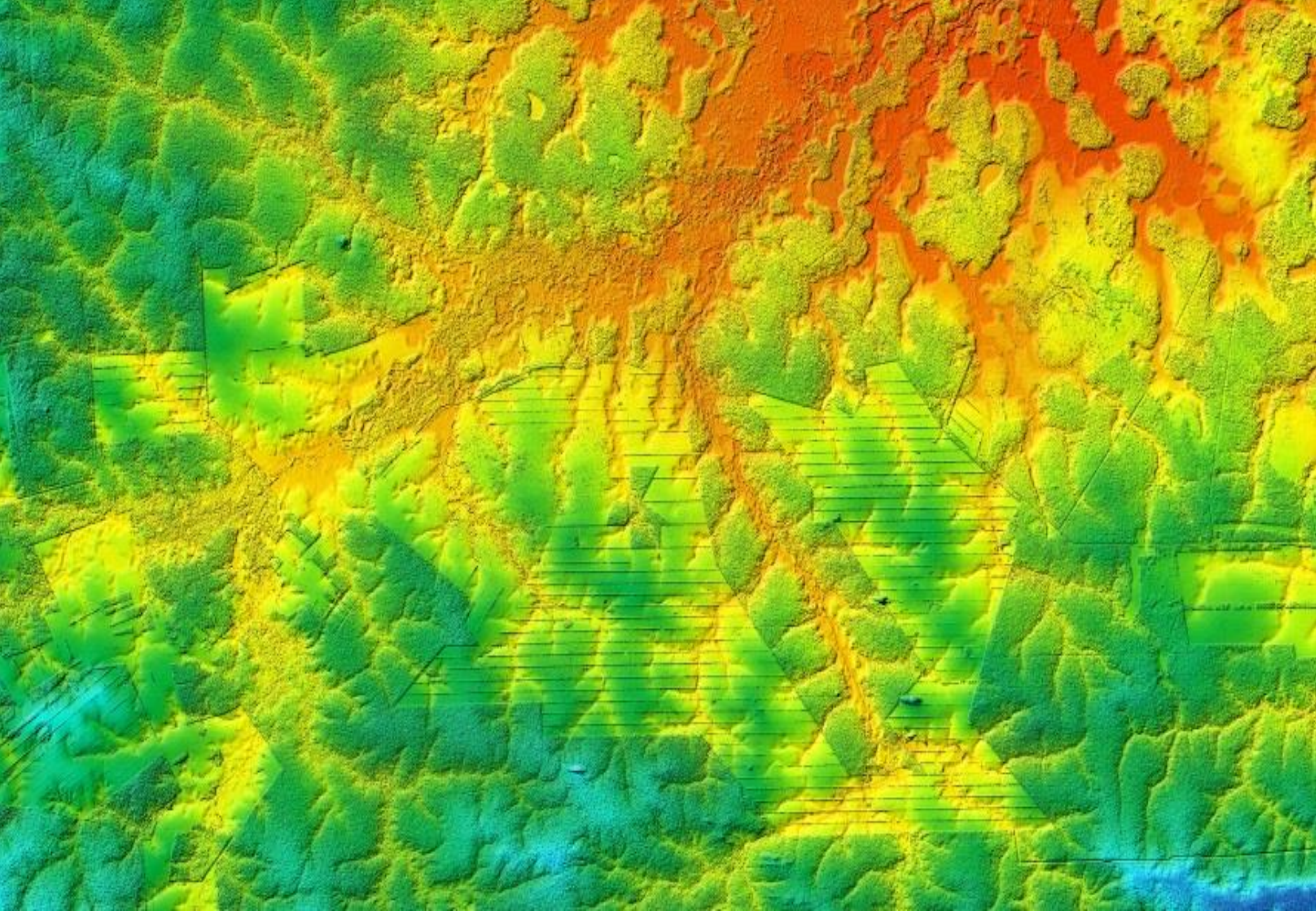
- $\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Temporal}}$... temporal decorrelation
- γ_{SNR} ... additive noise decorrelation
- $\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Volume}}$... geometric decorrelation

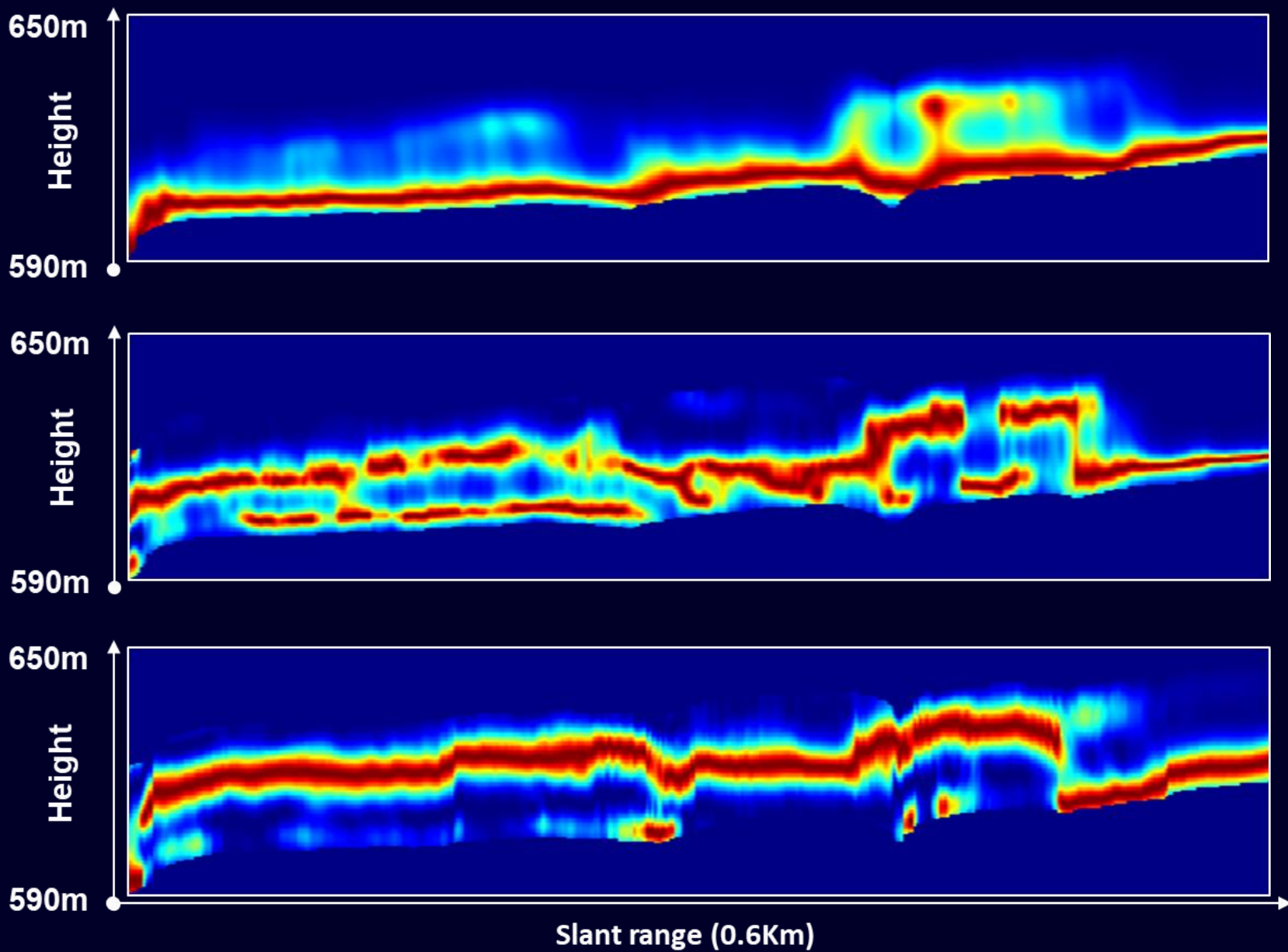
The **phase (center)** of is γ_{Vol} associated to the **center of mass of $f(z)$** : The phase center height $h_{\text{Int}} = k_z \phi_{\text{Int}}$ corresponds to the height of the center of mass of $f(z)$ with respect to z_0 !!!



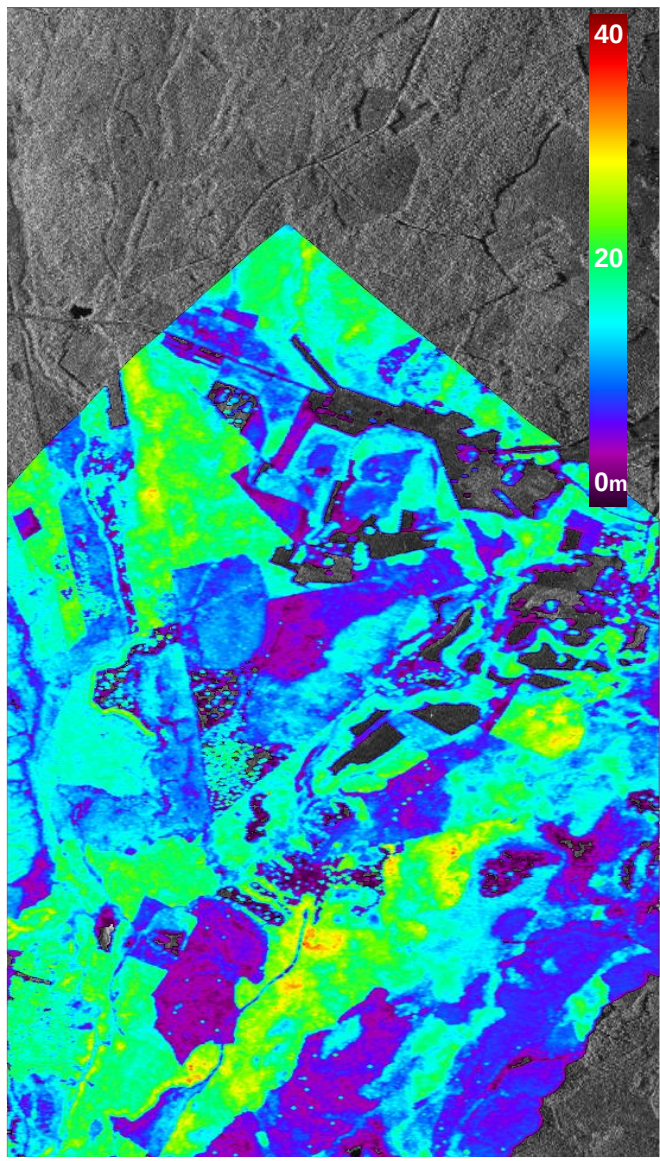
DEM, Rain Forest, Bolivia



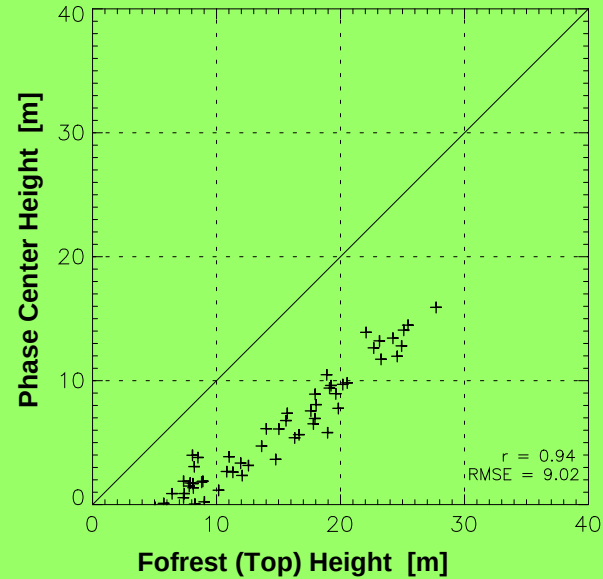




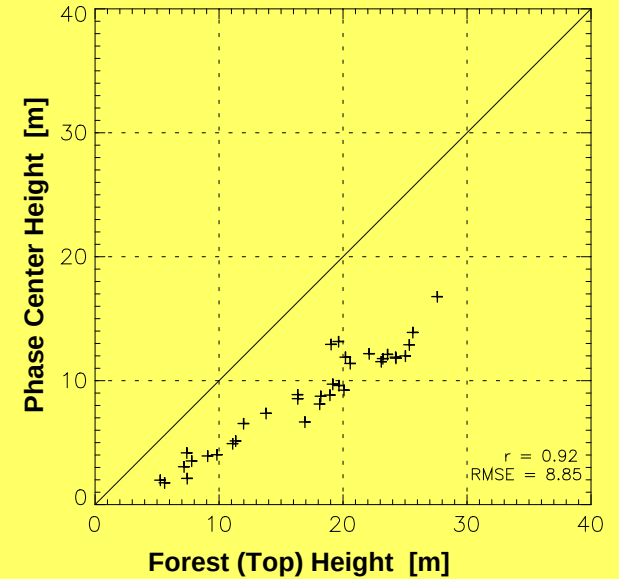
Test Site: Krycklan, Sweden



Half Baseline



Full Baseline



Forest Height inversion from InSAR Data



$$\tilde{\gamma}(s_1, s_2) = \frac{\langle s_1 s_2^* \rangle}{\sqrt{\langle s_1 s_1^* \rangle \langle s_2 s_2^* \rangle}}$$

Interferometric Coherence (complex)

$$\tilde{\gamma}(s_1, s_2) = \gamma_{\text{Sys}} \gamma_{\text{Tmp}} \tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}$$

$\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}$... volume decorrelation $\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Tmp}}$... temporal decorrelation

$$\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Vol}}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = e^{i\kappa_z z_0} \frac{\int_0^{h_v} f(z, \vec{w}) e^{i\kappa_z z} dz}{\int_0^{h_v} f(z, \vec{w}) dz}$$

$f(z, \vec{w})$... vertical reflectivity function κ_z ... vertical wavenumber

Interferometric (volume) decorrelation is sensitive to the „visible“ (forest) **height** and to the **vertical reflectivity function** $f(z, \vec{w})$ within the interferometric resolution cell.



Forest Height inversion challenges:

- The parameterisation / description of $f(z, \vec{w})$
- The presence of $\tilde{\gamma}_{\text{Tmp}}$

2 Layer Inversion Model: (Random) Volume over Ground RVoG



Volume Layer Ground Layer

$$f(z, \vec{w}) = m_V f_V(z) + m_G(\vec{w}) \delta(z - z_0)$$

Volume Layer Coherence

$$\tilde{Y}_V = \frac{I}{I_0} \left\{ \begin{array}{l} I = \int_0^{h_V} \exp(ik_z z') f_V(z') dz' \\ I_0 = \int_0^{h_V} f_V(z') dz' \end{array} \right.$$

$$\tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = \exp(i\phi_0) \frac{\tilde{Y}_V(\kappa_z) + m(\vec{w})}{1 + m(\vec{w})}$$

$$m(\vec{w}) = \frac{m_G(\vec{w})}{m_V(\vec{w}) I_0} \quad \kappa_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$$

$f_V(z)$... volume reflectivity function

$\phi_0 = k_z z_0$... underlying topography

Single Baseline Observations

single- / dual- / quad-pol

$$\tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}_1, \kappa_z) \quad \tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}_2, \kappa_z) \quad \tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}_3, \kappa_z)$$

1, 2, or 3 complex coherences

Total Coherence

$$\tilde{Y}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = Y_{Temp}(\kappa_z) \tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z)$$

For a Single Baseline

3+N unknown parameters

Volume Height h_V

Topography ϕ_0

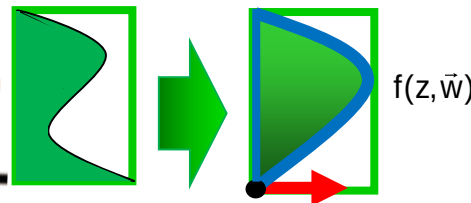
G/V Ratio $m(\vec{w}) = f(\text{pol})$

$f_V(z)$... N parameters

plus one more

Temporal Deco Y_{Temp}

for repeat-pass implementations



2 Layer Inversion Model with exponential volume reflectivity



Volume Layer Ground Layer

$$f(z, \vec{w}) = m_V f_V(z) + m_G(\vec{w}) \delta(z - z_0)$$

➔

$$\tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = \exp(i\phi_0) \frac{\tilde{Y}_V(\kappa_z) + m(\vec{w})}{1 + m(\vec{w})}$$

Volume Layer Coherence

$$\tilde{Y}_V = \frac{I}{I_0} \left\{ \begin{array}{l} I = \int_0^{h_V} \exp(ik_z z') e^{\left(\frac{2 \sigma z'}{\cos \theta_0}\right)} dz' \\ I_0 = \int_0^{h_V} e^{\left(\frac{2 \sigma z'}{\cos \theta_0}\right)} dz' \end{array} \right.$$

$$m(\vec{w}) = \frac{m_G(\vec{w})}{m_V(\vec{w}) I_0} \quad \kappa_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$$

$$f_V(z) = \exp\left(\frac{2 \sigma z}{\cos \theta_0}\right) \quad \text{exponential volume reflectivity}$$

Single Baseline Observations

single- / dual- / quad-pol

$$\tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}_1, \kappa_z) \quad \tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}_2, \kappa_z) \quad \tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}_3, \kappa_z)$$

1, 2, or 3 complex coherences

Total Coherence

$$\tilde{Y}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = Y_{Temp}(\kappa_z) \tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z)$$

For a Single Baseline

4 unknown parameters

Volume Height h_V

Topography ϕ_0

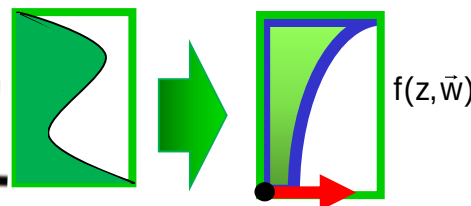
G/V Ratio $m(\vec{w}) = f(\text{pol})$

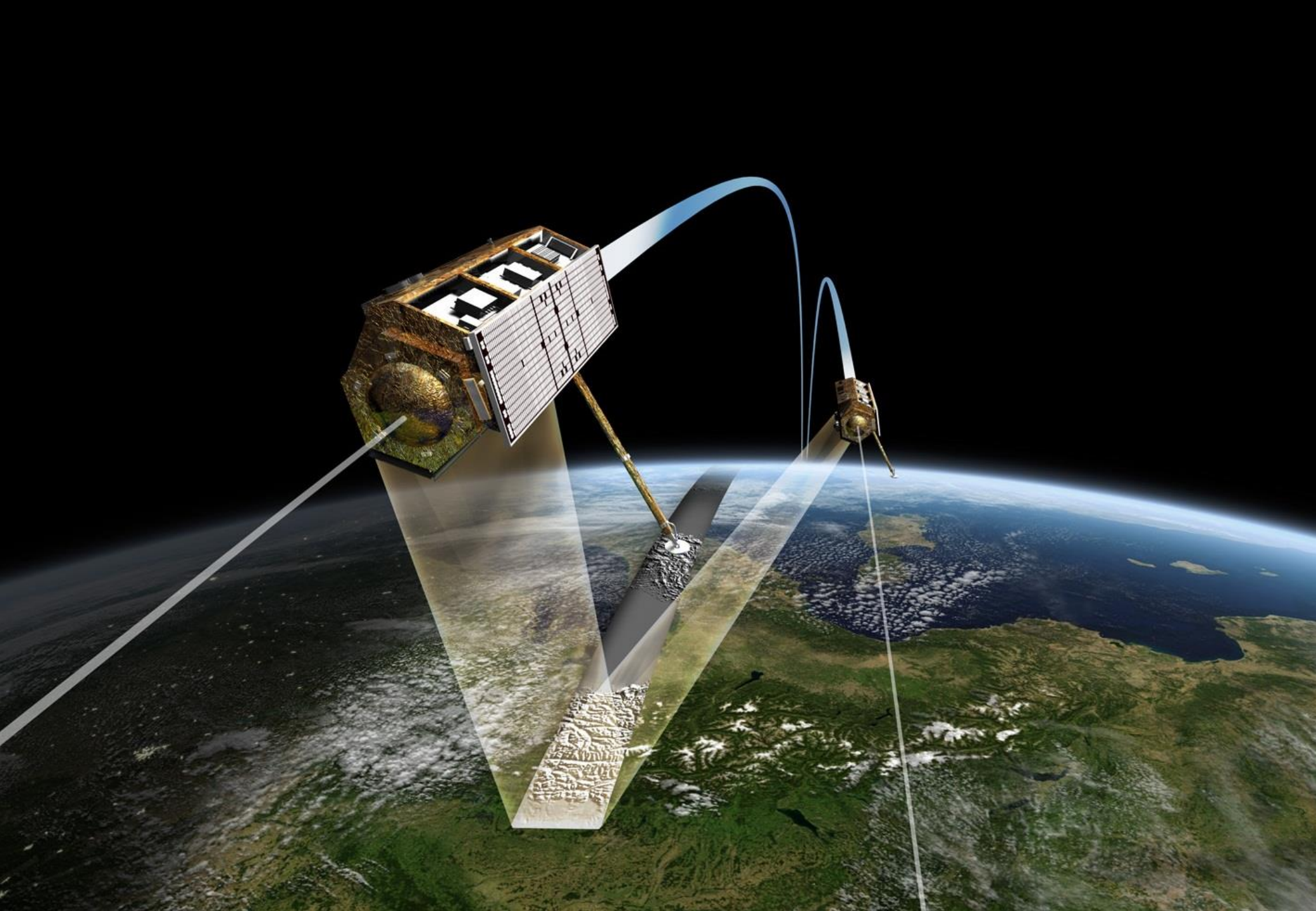
$f_V(z)$... 1 parameter (σ)

plus one more

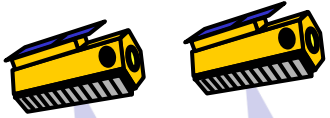
Temporal Deco Y_{Temp}

for repeat-pass implementations





TanDEM-X: 2 Layer model with exp. volume reflectivity



Volume Layer Ground Layer

$$f(z, \vec{w}) = m_V f_V(z) + m_G(\vec{w}) \delta(z - z_0)$$

Volume Layer Coherence

$$\tilde{Y}_V = \frac{I}{I_0} \left\{ \begin{array}{l} I = \int_0^{h_V} \exp(ik_z z') e^{\left(\frac{2 \sigma z'}{\cos \theta_0}\right)} dz' \\ I_0 = \int_0^{h_V} e^{\left(\frac{2 \sigma z'}{\cos \theta_0}\right)} dz' \end{array} \right.$$

$$m(\vec{w}) = \frac{m_G(\vec{w})}{m_V(\vec{w}) I_0} \quad \kappa_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$$

$$\tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = \exp(i\phi_0) \frac{\tilde{Y}_V(\kappa_z) + m(\vec{w})}{1 + m(\vec{w})}$$

$$f_V(z) = \exp\left(\frac{2 \sigma z}{\cos \theta_0}\right) \quad \text{exponential volume reflectivity}$$

Single Baseline Observation(s)

single-pol

$$\tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}_1, \kappa_z)$$

1 complex coherence

Total Coherence

$$\tilde{Y}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = \tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z)$$

For a Single Baseline

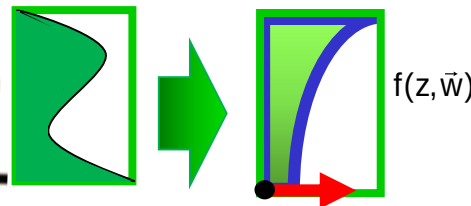
4 unknown parameters

Volume Height h_V

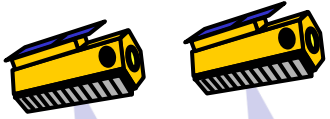
Topography ϕ_0

G/V Ratio $m(\vec{w}) = f(\text{pol})$

$f_V(z)$... 1 parameter (σ)



TanDEM-X: 2 Layer model with exp. volume reflectivity + no ground



Invertible with single-pol data only if the ground topography φ_0 is known !!!

Volume Layer Ground Layer

$$f(z, \vec{w}) = m_V f_V(z) + m_G(\vec{w}) \delta(z - z_0)$$

$$\tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = \exp(i\varphi_0) \frac{\tilde{Y}_V(\kappa_z) + m_G(\vec{w})}{1 + m_V(\vec{w})}$$

Volume Layer Coherence

$$\tilde{Y}_V = \frac{I}{I_0} \left\{ \begin{array}{l} I = \int_0^{h_V} \exp(ik_z z') e^{\left(\frac{2\sigma z'}{\cos\theta_0}\right)} dz' \\ I_0 = \int_0^{h_V} e^{\left(\frac{2\sigma z'}{\cos\theta_0}\right)} dz' \end{array} \right.$$

$$f_V(z) = \exp\left(\frac{2\sigma z}{\cos\theta_0}\right) \quad \text{exponential volume reflectivity}$$

$$\kappa_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$$

Single Baseline Observation(s)

single-pol

$$\tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}_1, \kappa_z)$$

1 complex coherence

Total Coherence

$$\tilde{Y}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = \tilde{Y}_{Temp}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) \tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z)$$

For a Single Baseline

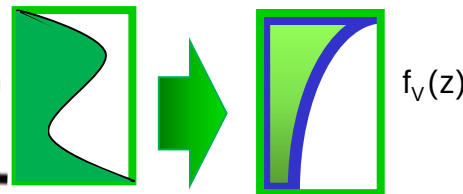
3 unknown parameters

Volume Height h_V

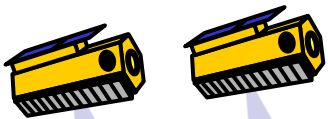
Topography φ_0

GN Ratio $m_V(\vec{w}) = \kappa(\rho, \sigma)$

$f_V(z)$... 1 parameter (σ)



TanDEM-X: 2 Layer model with ct. volume reflectivity + no ground



Volume Layer Ground Layer

$$f(z, \vec{w}) = m_V f_V(z) + m_G(\vec{w}) \delta(z - z_0)$$

➔

$$\tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = \exp(i\phi_0) \frac{\tilde{Y}_V(\kappa_z) + m_G(\vec{w})}{1 + m_V(\vec{w})}$$

Volume Layer Coherence

$$\tilde{Y}_V = \exp(i \frac{h_V \kappa_z}{2}) \frac{\sin(\frac{h_V \kappa_z}{2})}{(\frac{h_V \kappa_z}{2})}$$

$$\frac{m_G(\vec{w})}{m_V(\vec{w}) I_0} \kappa_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$$

$f_V(z) = \text{ct.}$ constant volume reflectivity (box profile)

Single Baseline Observation(s)

single-pol ✓

$$\tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}_1, \kappa_z)$$

1 complex coherence

Total Coherence

$$\tilde{Y}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = \tilde{Y}_{Vol}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z)$$

For a Single Baseline

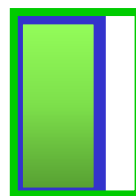
2 unknown parameters

Volume Height h_V

Topography ϕ_0

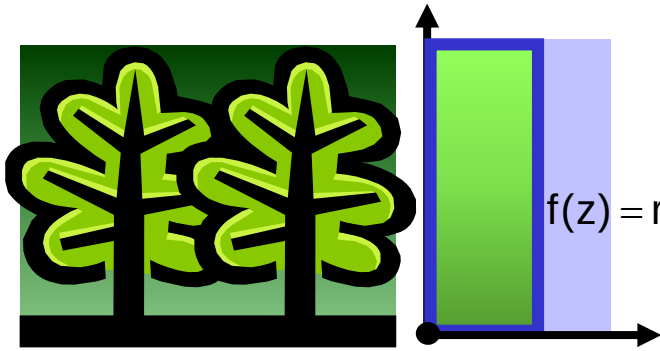
GN Ratio $m_G(\vec{w}) = \kappa \Delta \theta / \sin(\theta_0)$

$f_V(z)$ 1 parameter

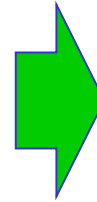


$f_V(z)$

Box-Profile and Sinc-Inversion



$$f(z) = \text{rect}(z) = \begin{cases} \sigma_{v0} & \text{when } 0 \leq z \leq h_v \\ 0 & \text{when } z > h_v \end{cases}$$



$$\tilde{Y}_{\text{Vol}}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = \exp(i(\phi_0 + \frac{h_v \kappa_z}{2})) \frac{\sin\left(\frac{h_v \kappa_z}{2}\right)}{\left(\frac{h_v \kappa_z}{2}\right)}$$

Total Coherence: $\tilde{Y}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z) = Y_{\text{Sys}} \tilde{Y}_{\text{Vol}}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z)$

System Decorrelation: $Y_{\text{Sys}} = 0.97$

Volume (Forest) Height: h_v Topography: ϕ_0

Vertical Wavenumber: $\kappa_z = \frac{\kappa \Delta \theta}{\sin(\theta_0)}$

Inversion: $|\tilde{Y}_{\text{Vol}}(\kappa_z)| = \frac{|\tilde{Y}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z)|}{|Y_{\text{Sys}}|} = \frac{\left| \frac{\sin\left(\frac{h_v \kappa_z}{2}\right)}{\left(\frac{h_v \kappa_z}{2}\right)} \right|}{1} \rightarrow h_v \approx \frac{2\pi}{\kappa_z} \left[1 - \frac{2}{\pi} \sin^{-1} \left(\frac{|\tilde{Y}(\vec{w}, \kappa_z)|^{0.8}}{|Y_{\text{Sys}}|^{0.8}} \right) \right]$

The Pol-InSAR Course

Part 5: SAR Interferometry 3

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